force behind this department and is the main person responsible for the success or failure of the team. He/she assigns the various job responsibilities of the sales force and when need be, can also restructure the sales team to function more efficiently. The sales manager is the head of the department and everyone reports to him/her.

Assistant sales manager

The assistant sales manager assists the manager. The assistant sales manager has a number of responsibilities and is second in command. Though his/her responsibilities vary from organization to organization some main duties includes: designating tasks to the team leaders, handling the manager's affairs, hiring and firing employees, and ensuring that the tasks assigned are all completed on time and are properly done.

Team leaders

Team leaders are in charge of the sales personnel and fall directly under the management of the assistant sales manager. These team leaders are usually assigned specified team tasks which they have to complete within a stipulated period of time. They head a sales team of 4 to 5 sales people and are responsible for getting the task assigned to them completed.

Sales personnel

The sales personnel are directly answerable to the team leader. They are usually involved in the day to day sales activities of the organization and are assessed on the sales that they can finalize.

8.4 Product Life Cycle

When a product is introduced in a market it passes through a series of stages and the concept from launching of product till it is withdrawn is called as product life cycle. There are four stages in the product life cycle which is introduction, growth, maturity and decline. Each stage has a particular level of sales, profit and competition.

1) **Introduction:** When the new product is launched costs are high due to sales promotion, research and product development. The customers are first time buyers and the success or failure depends on the promotional techniques adopted by the food service institutions.
2) **Growth:** As the market expands the first time customers become repeat customers and therefore sales and profit can be high.
3) **Maturity:** In the maturity stage costs may increase as there is competition in the market and the growth of the organization may slow down if it is not managed properly.
4) **Decline:** The market becomes saturated with products and demand falls but the supply release in abundance. Therefore every food service organizations should try to be in the market by launching new foods or recipes according to the needs of the customers which will be constantly changing.

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